

choose the correct settings in the 'Print' dialog box. For this, click 'Printer properties', and set the print quality to the highest possible value. Also choose 'photo paper,' if you are using one, as the paper type; use high resolution.

Customising images

First off, the photo that you want to print should have a resolution of at least 300 dpi, otherwise the prints won't be good enough. If you're scanning a photo to print, scan it at 300 dpi. Use a format such as TIFF that preserves the colours and sharpness, if you intend to print the image. You should therefore also save your digital camera images in the TIFF format, if there's an option to do so. Also, don't enlarge the image using an image-editing software. This is because an image of 1280 x 960 pixels at 72 dpi, has the same amount of details, as a 4 x 3-inch image at 300 dpi. However, this also means that you can safely use a 1280 x 960 pixel image to print a 4 by 3-inch photo.

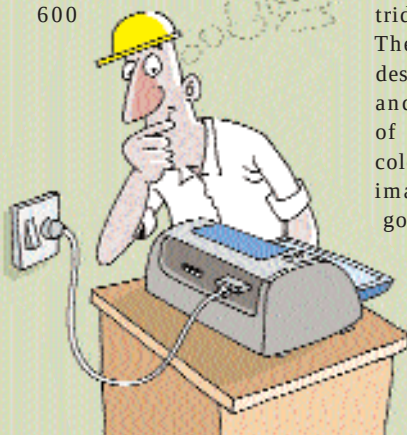
You might notice that the printed image doesn't look exactly like the one on the screen—this is simply because the images on the screen are in the RGB (red, green and blue) format, and the printer uses CMYK inks (cyan, magenta, yellow and black). There are colours that can be rendered in RGB, but not in CMYK. To avoid this problem, convert your image to the CMYK mode, using

image editing software such as Adobe Photoshop, or PaintShop Pro.

Also use a photo editing software to edit your image, to correct the red eye, dust and specks problems. You can use sharpening filters to improve photo edges.

Print settings and paper

Next comes the printer. The printer should be able to print at least 600



x 600 dpi. The higher the dpi, the better will be the quality of the printed images. You also need to keep your printer drivers updated.

The next step now, is to adjust the print settings. Set the print-quality to maximum, and choose the right paper setting, as it controls the amount of ink that gets onto the paper. It's better to use the same brand of paper as your printer's as a company usually customises its paper for its printers.

After printing, you need to allow the printout to dry.

Normally, the drying time is one hour. If the photo will be in close contact with something else—for example, if you're going to frame it—it's better to let it dry for 24 hours. If you are printing multiple copies, remove each copy from the printer as soon as it is printed.

Printing black and white photos

The best way to print black and white photos is to print them using the colour cartridge. Yes, you read right! The black cartridge is designed to print black text, and cannot produce shades of grey as efficiently as a colour cartridge can. Use an image-editing software for good quality results. Open

the photograph in your favourite image editing tool, and convert the photo to greyscale. Now, print the photograph with 'Automatic' colour settings, the

highest print quality and the correct paper type. You'll get a fine photo.

Power Tips

Printing marked selection

When printing selected text say on a Web page, select the text, and go to **File > Print**. If you're using Internet Explorer 5 or higher, choose to print 'Selection' in the dialog box that pops up. Most of the newer browsers have the Print Preview in the File menu. This feature can be very useful if you want to print only selected pages.



Use the Print dialog box in Internet Explorer to choose what you want to print

Decide upon the pages that you want to print in the Print Preview dialog box, and then click 'Print...'. Now in the Print dialog box, enter the page numbers and click OK. This procedure is practically the same for most browsers, including Netscape.

Printing large documents

Sometimes, you might want to print a large document that is laid out in many pages—one being the index page, and all the chapters linked to it. Internet Explorer has an easy solution for this problem. Just print the index page, and in the Print dialog box, tick the 'Print all linked documents' option.

Printing with background

By default, the background of the page—that may include images—is not printed. To print background images and colours in Internet Explorer, go to **Tools > 'Internet Options...'**. Click on the Advanced tab, and scroll down to Printing. Here, tick the box that says 'Print back-



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